

AI Log

Ali Nadirov AI Usage Log

Project: Doner na Abaya Website

Course: Introduction to Web Technologies

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In this project, I used AI tools such as ChatGPT to understand CSS concepts, check why specific CSS rules behaved in a certain way, and improve my understanding of the CSS requirements. I did not use AI to generate my stylesheet. I wrote and edited the CSS myself and used AI mainly to explain concepts and help me understand problems in my own code.

Prompt 1

AI Tool: ChatGPT

Prompt: "Why can the margin of a heading move the whole section instead of only moving the heading?"

Why I asked:

I needed to understand the margin collapse requirement from the assignment. I noticed that changing the top margin of a heading could affect the position of the surrounding section instead of creating the spacing I expected.

How I used the answer:

ChatGPT explained that vertical margins can collapse between a parent and its first child when there is no border or padding separating them. I used this explanation to understand why padding can be used when I need spacing inside the section. This helped me understand the margin-collapse comment required in the assignment.

Prompt 2

AI Tool: ChatGPT

Prompt: "What is the difference between CSS Grid and Flexbox, and why would Grid be suitable for a section with columns of content?"

Why I asked:

My About and Gallery pages use both Grid and Flexbox, and I needed to understand why they are used for different blocks instead of using one layout method everywhere.

How I used the answer:

I learned that Grid is useful for arranging content in rows and columns, while Flexbox is useful for arranging items along a flexible row or column. This helped me understand why I used Grid for `.restaurant-intro` and `.gallery-section`, while using Flexbox for `.offer-list` and `.form-actions`.

Prompt 3**AI Tool:** ChatGPT

Prompt: "How does CSS specificity work when two class selectors target the same element?"

Why I asked:

The assignment requires a specificity experiment with two conflicting rules. I wanted to understand why `.offers-section .offer-card` overrides `.offer-card`.

How I used the answer:

I learned that `.offer-card` has specificity `0-1-0`, while `.offers-section .offer-card` has specificity `0-2-0`. Therefore, the second rule has greater specificity and its `border-color` value is applied. I kept both rules in my stylesheet and added comments explaining the experiment.

Prompt 4**AI Tool:** ChatGPT

Prompt: "What does `clear: both` do when an image is floated?"

Why I asked:

I used `float: left` on the `.branch-photo` image on my About page. I needed to understand why another content block needed `clear: both`.

How I used the answer:

I learned that `clear: both` prevents the following block from being positioned beside a left- or right-floated element. I used this understanding in `.branch-info`, where `clear: both` places the information block below the floated restaurant photo.

Prompt 5

AI Tool: ChatGPT

Prompt: "How do `position: relative` and `position: absolute` work together?"

Why I asked:

My About page contains a 24/7 badge inside `.branch-details`. I wanted to understand why the parent needs `position: relative` when the badge uses `position: absolute`.

How I used the answer:

I learned that a relatively positioned parent can establish the containing block used for positioning an absolutely positioned child. I used this concept with `.branch-details` and `.opening-badge`, so the badge stays positioned inside the branch information block.

Prompt 6

AI Tool: ChatGPT

Prompt: "What does `flex: 1 1 250px` mean when used on flex items?"

Why I asked:

The assignment requires flex items that can grow or shrink. My offer cards use `flex: 1 1 250px`, and I wanted to understand the three values instead of using the property without knowing its meaning.

How I used the answer:

I learned that the first value controls how an item can grow, the second controls how it can shrink, and the third value gives its initial flex basis. I used this in `.offer-card` so the offer cards can share available space while still having a reasonable starting width.

Alikhan AI Usage Log

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In this project, our team used AI tools (Gemini and ChatGPT) only to understand CSS layout theory, fix positioning bugs, and learn how specific properties work. We wrote all the CSS code in the Alikhan-Kuttybayev.css file ourselves. We did not use AI to generate our stylesheets or design our layout structure.

Prompt 1 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "Why is the top margin of my h2 not pushing it down inside the section, but moving the whole section down instead?" Why we asked: We noticed that the margins of our h2 and the section collapsed into one instead of adding up. How we used the answer: Gemini explained margin collapse. We fixed it by using padding-top on the section because padding never collapses.

Prompt 2 AI Tool: ChatGPT Prompt: "How can I center a position: absolute badge perfectly in the middle of its parent?" Why we asked: We were trying to place the .halal-badge exactly in the middle at the top of the .info-note box. Using left: 50% made it off-center because it put the left edge of the badge in the middle. How we used the answer: The AI showed us how to use transform: translateX(-50%) to pull the badge back by exactly half of its own width. We added this rule to our stylesheet.

Prompt 3 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "How to override a CSS class rule without using !important?" Why we asked: We were running a specificity experiment and wanted to resolve a border color conflict on the review cards without relying on !important. How we used the answer: The AI explained that an ID outweighs any number of classes. We raised the specificity of the rule we wanted to win by adding the #customer-reviews ID in front of the .review-card class.

Prompt 4 AI Tool: Claude Prompt: "How to make flexbox items automatically go to the next line if there isn't enough space?" Why we asked: We wanted our drink groups to automatically grow into free space, shrink when it is tight, and wrap on smaller screens. How we used the answer: Claude explained the flex-wrap: wrap property. We added this to our .drink-groups container and set the flex-basis on the .drink-group items to 280px so they behave exactly as needed.

Nurasyl AI Usage Log

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In this project, I used AI tools (Gemini) to explore and understand CSS theory, layout systems, and styling rules for future implementation. We wrote the code and main project content ourselves.

Prompt 1 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "What is centering in CSS?" Why we asked: I needed to understand how to align elements horizontally and vertically using modern CSS methods instead of deprecated HTML tags. How we used the answer: Gemini provided methods for centering text, block elements, and using Flexbox/Grid. I used this theory to understand modern alignment techniques.

Prompt 2 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "What is Flexbox?" Why we asked: I wanted to learn about 1D layout systems to arrange elements in rows or columns and make them responsive. How we used the answer: The AI explained the core concepts of Flex containers, main/cross axes, and alignment properties, which helped me understand responsive single-direction layouts.

Prompt 3 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "CSS grid using explanation" Why we asked: I needed to understand how to build two-dimensional layouts with rows and columns for things like card grids or photo galleries. How we used the answer: The AI provided syntax for setting up a grid container and placing items. I learned how to use fractional units (fr) and control track sizes.

Prompt 4 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "What is the difference between Flexbox and Grid?" Why we asked: I was confused about when to use Flexbox versus CSS Grid for structuring page elements. How we used the answer: Gemini compared the two, clarifying that Flexbox is content-first (1D) and Grid is layout-first (2D). This helped me understand which tool to choose for different UI components.

Prompt 5 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "What is specificity?" Why we asked: I needed to understand how browsers decide which CSS rule applies when multiple conflicting rules target the exact same element. How we used the answer: The AI explained the 4-category scoring system (Inline, IDs, Classes, Elements). This theory helped me understand how to avoid CSS conflicts in stylesheets.

Prompt 6 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "What does position: relative do?" Why we asked: I wanted to know how element positioning works without breaking the normal document flow of the web page. How we used the answer: The AI explained that it preserves original space while allowing offsets, and acts as an anchor for absolute children. I used this knowledge to understand layout stacking and the z-index.

Prompt 7 AI Tool: Gemini Prompt: "how to create columns in css and make the size of them" Why we asked: I needed to explore different ways to split content into columns and control their widths across the screen. How we used the answer: Gemini provided examples using CSS Grid, Flexbox, and CSS Multi-Column. I learned which method fits best for structural page layouts versus flowing text.